18.5 Major Depressive Disorder*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "Nothing will ever get better." • "I am a burden." **Objective** • Flat affect; slowed movements • Withdrawn; stays in bed • Little eye contact	**ACTUAL** Impaired mood regulation related to depressive illness as evidenced by persistent low mood, negative statements about the future and withdrawal.	• Names one goal for the future within 1 week.	• Assess mood and suicide risk on admission and at regular intervals. • Make brief, frequent contacts. • Encourage small, achievable activities. • Give antidepressants as prescribed and judge their effect. • Refer for psychotherapy.	• Met when a goal is named.
Subjective • "I do not feel like eating or washing." **Objective** • Lost 4 kg • Poor hygiene	**ACTUAL** Decreased self-care ability syndrome related to depressed mood and reduced energy as evidenced by poor hygiene and reduced intake.	• Washes daily and eats at least half of each meal.	• Set up a simple daily routine. • Offer small meals and foods he likes. • Prompt and support hygiene without doing it for him.	• Achieved as self-care improves.
Subjective • "Sometimes I wish I would not wake up." **Objective** • Feels hopeless • Socially isolated	**RISK** Risk for suicidal self-injurious behavior as evidenced by risk factors: depression, hopelessness and expressed wish to die.	• Stays safe and tells staff if the thoughts get stronger.	• Ask directly about suicidal thoughts and plans. • Remove means of harm per policy. • Keep to the ordered level of observation. • Agree with him how he will ask for help.	• Outcome reached while he remains safe.

* **References for this care plan:** [31], [35], [97], [120]. Full entries are listFull entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.